

Body builders

The human body is made up of trillions of microscopic cells. Each cell is a living unit with a complex structure. Inside each cell are even smaller structures called organelles that control, produce, and move materials, release energy, and work together to keep the cell alive.

Inside a cell

Although cells come in many shapes and sizes, they all share the same basic structure. Each cell has a membrane, or outer layer, that surrounds the cell. Inside the membrane is a liquid, called cytoplasm, which supports all the different organelles.

Lysosomes recycle worn-out organelles

The **nucleus** is the cell's control center

Cytoplasm is a jellylike fluid that contains organelles

An organelle called the **Golgi complex** prepares proteins for use inside and outside the cell.



Structure of a typical cell, showing organelles

